BUSIATE ALLA PESTO TRAPANESE

REGION	SERVES	TOTAL TIME
South	**4-6**	**1 h plus the dough rest**

INGREDIENTS

545 g	Cherry tomatoes
10 g	Garlic cloves
10	Basil leaves
100 g	Sicilian almonds, coarsely chopped
75 g	Olive oil, plus more to cover
68 g	Pecorino romano
quantity not given	Salt
1 batch	Semolina dough

METHOD

1. Bring a small pot of water to the boil over high heat. Set up an ice-water bath with a colander sitting in it.
2. Score an X into the base of each tomato with a sharp paring knife. Drop them into the boiling water for 5 to 10 seconds to loosen the skins, then move them to the ice bath with a slotted spoon. After 30 seconds, lift them into a bowl, slip the skins off and discard them. Lay the tomatoes on a kitchen towel to shed any water they are still carrying.
3. Tip the tomatoes into a high-speed blender. Add the garlic and pulse gently to a puree. Add the basil and keep going, then the almonds, blending to a thick, uniform paste.
4. With the blender on low, drizzle in the 75 g of oil. Once it is smooth, scrape it into a mixing bowl and fold the cheese through until well combined. Taste and add salt.
5. Measure out 383 g of the pesto for this dish. Put the rest in an airtight container under a film of olive oil and refrigerate up to 3 days.
6. Make 624 g of busiate from the semolina dough.
7. Salt a large pot of water generously and bring it to the boil.
8. Cook the busiate 3 to 5 minutes, to al dente.
9. Put the measured pesto in a large mixing bowl. Lift the pasta straight into it with a spider or pasta basket. Toss gently and feed in pasta water 15 g at a time until the pesto turns creamy and coats every strand.
10. Divide into bowls.

NOTES

The pesto never goes near the heat. It is married to the pasta in a bowl, loosened with pasta water a tablespoon at a time.
Pesto alla trapanese is Genoese pesto rebuilt on Sicilian ingredients. Almonds take the place of pine nuts, ripe tomato pushes basil into the background, and some versions work mint in.
A blender or food processor gives the smooth, Genoese-like paste this recipe aims at. By mortar and pestle you can stop wherever you like, and the traditional texture is rougher than this.
Whether to put cheese in at all is contested. This version folds in 68 g pecorino romano.
The recipe makes more pesto than the dish needs. Keep the surplus sealed under oil.

SHAPE
Busiate

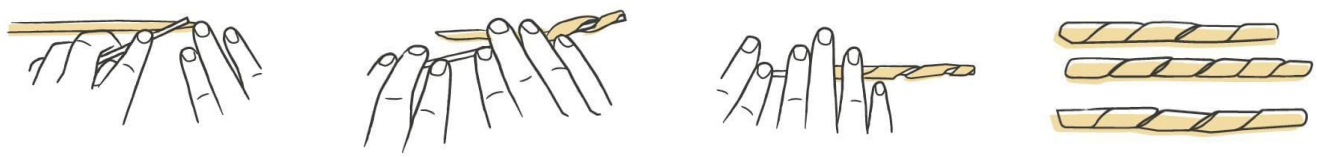
Region: Western Sicily, and Sardinia, where it is called busa / Rest: 1 to 2 hours at room temperature

METHOD

1. Make semolina dough. Dust a wooden board with a little 00 flour. Line a sheet pan with parchment, then dust the parchment with semolina.
2. Quarter the dough. Work one piece and keep the rest under plastic wrap or a towel.
3. Press the piece into a thick rope by hand. Set the fingertips of both hands together at its midpoint, then roll back and forth while walking your hands apart toward the ends.
4. Keep rolling under light pressure until the rope is about 1/4 inch across. Cut it in half and roll the halves separately if it gets too long to handle.
5. Cut the rope into 3-inch lengths with a knife or bench scraper. Cover the pieces you are not shaping.

6. Take one 3-inch piece and roll it out the same way until it is 1/8 inch across and 6 inches long.
7. Lay the rope parallel to the edge of the board. Press the maccheroni iron into its right end with the iron's left end angled underneath, spread four fingers of each hand along the iron, and roll it up and away from you, flattening the rope lightly as it winds into a tight coil.
8. Turn the coil back parallel to you and roll it gently on the board to even out the thickness. Push too hard and the pasta grips the iron, then unwinds as you pull it off.
9. Ease the shape off the iron onto the sheet pan. Work through the rest of the cut pieces.
10. Repeat from step 3 with the remaining dough.
11. Dry 1 to 2 hours at room temperature, until the pasta stiffens slightly and holds its shape when handled.
12. To hold it, wrap the pan in plastic and refrigerate up to 24 hours.

SHAPING



1 2 3 4

NOTES

Dimensions run 1/4-inch rope, cut at 3 inches, then each piece re-rolled to 1/8 inch by 6 inches before shaping.
Needs a ferretto, or maccheroni iron. The name comes from busa, the Mediterranean reed once used in place of the iron.
The coil is tight, unlike the wide open coil of fileja. Consistency in tightness and thickness is the hard part, and the fix is one steady unbroken roll rather than several passes.
Drying is not optional here. An underdried spiral relaxes and loses its coil in the boiling water.
Refrigerator limit is 24 hours.
Traditional pairing is pesto alla trapanese. It also takes red sauce, fresh tomato sauce, and a heavy ragù such as pork sugo.

DOUGH

Semolina Dough

Makes: 750 g / Active Time: 10-15 min kneading / Rest: 30 min minimum, wrapped

INGREDIENTS

325 g	Tipo 00 flour
175 g	Semolina flour
250 g	Lukewarm water
up to 1 tbsp, only if dry	Room-temperature water

METHOD

1. Stir the two flours together thoroughly, then mound on a wooden surface with a well 5 to 6 inches across.
2. Add the water slowly. Water has no body of its own, so it escapes far more easily than yolks do.
3. Draw in flour from the inner wall with a fork as you pour, working round the circumference until all the water is in.
4. Knead 10 to 15 minutes, pressing down and away, rotating, folding.
5. Add water by the tablespoon only if it stays dry.
6. Wrap and rest at least 30 minutes.

NOTES

Eggless, so it stays more elastic and less tender than egg dough. Do not expect the Play-Doh feel here.
50% hydration against 500 g total flour.
65% of the flour is 00 and 35% semolina.
Keeps 24 hours. Chilled overnight, pull it out 20 minutes before rolling.

DATE ___ / ___ / ___ RATING ___ / 5 OVEN ADJ _____

NOTES _____

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